Too Much for You

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/86305666.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Glimmer (mentioned), Bow (mentioned), Bow's Dads (Mentioned)

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Post-Canon, Domestic Fluff, Protective Catra (She-Ra), POV Catra (She-Ra), Adora Needs Therapy (She-Ra), Catra is Bad at Feelings (She-Ra), Meadows, Songs

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by AuthorWithoutaName

Summary

It's been some time since Prime's defeat. Slowly, Etheria has recovered. When there was a lot of work to do, Adora's mind couldn't wander. She was focused. As time passes, and things have gone quiet and peaceful, Adora doesn't seem okay anymore. She isn't herself. She isn't sleeping. She always seems stressed and on edge.

After a suggestion from Bow, Catra takes Adora out for a walk in a meadow. Maybe if it's just the two of them, she can coax the blonde into talking and find out what's really going on... Or maybe... She can at least convince Adora to rest for a moment. Either one of those things would be alright.

(Based on the prompt C1 and C2 go on a quiet day in the meadow. C1 falls asleep while C2 is softly singing along with a song. This week's weekly prompt in the SPOP Creative Flex Discord server)

Notes

It's been awhile. I'm using this week's prompt in the SPOP Creative Flex server to ease myself back into writing and posting. I have *several* one-shots and unpublished chapters to my in-progress works on my computer. I need to finish them and post them, because right now, it feels like they're hanging over my head XD

The title is a nod to another show I like. I discovered the song at the end of this fic from that show. Not gonna name the show because of potential spoilers to it, but if you know, you know.

Anyway, hopefully ya'll enjoy this little one-shot!

See the end of the work for more notes

"So…"

Out of the corner of her eye, Catra watched Adora as she glanced this way and that. She wasn't sure if the blonde was admiring the foliage and colorful vegetation that surrounded them, or if she was scanning the meadow for any potential threats.

Adora… hadn't exactly been herself lately… or rather, as Glimmer had referred to it, Adora had been acting like fresh *ex*-Horde Adora. Jumping at sudden sounds. Blue-gray eyes narrowing and searching the shadows for *something*, or perhaps anything, that could somehow hurt ~~her~~ *them<\i>…*

Sparkles was convinced that Adora was afraid for herself, that she was being vigilant for her own safety. Sparkles didn't know shit. Adora wasn't scared for herself. She was afraid for them<\i>. All of them. Glimmer. Bow.

Herself<\i>… Catra reminded herself. She felt her face flush at the thought.

"How did you find this place again?" Adora asked.

Catra wasn't sure why, but she was slightly impressed that Adora could keep such a close eye on everything and still not slow down. Despite their consistent pace through the meadow, Catra had full confidence that Adora had fully ensured the shadows of the meadow held no threats.

"Arrow Boy." Catra answered simply. She felt a deep wave of appreciation for Bow. All of them (her, Glimmer, Bow), had noticed Adora's current state. All three of them had tried to help the blonde. The three of them had even had several<\i> secret meetings to discuss Adora.

Sparkles… Sparkles wasn't much help. Her ideas had been shit so far. Take Adora to Mystacore. Take Adora to a beach (Catra was pretty sure that she had washed more sand out of her fur last night, and the beach trip was a week ago!).

Bow had suggested that she take Adora to the meadow for a walk. Every idea before this one had involved trying to make Adora rest… Adora didn't rest! (Much to Catra's annoyance…).

"How did Bow know about this place?" Adora asked.

That was a good question. The problem was that Catra didn't know. She hadn't thought to ask him. She had been more focused on getting Adora to take a walk with her, maybe get a crack into the blonde's head, and try to figure out why<\i> Adora hasn't been able to sleep lately.

The bags under Adora's eyes had become even more prominent. The fire in her eyes had dimmed. She didn't walk with the confidence she had after Prime's defeat. She didn't carry the strong and heroic aura she always had. She seemed smaller now. She seemed quieter. And that scared Catra just a little.

Maybe that's why it was Arrow Boy who had thought of this little walk instead of her. Yeah… that's why. Believing that<\i> made her feel much better about being totally useless in this whole situation for the last two months.

"I don't know," Catra answered indifferently. She needed to get Adora talking soon. She needed to know what was wrong. Fixating on how Bow knew about this secret, non-Whispering Woods meadow was not gonna help Adora get over whatever she was dealing with.

"Maybe one of his dads told him?" Catra added. She hoped that was enough of an answer to satisfy the blonde.

They were a ways from the library now. For the last couple of days, the four of them had been staying with Bow's dads. Everything had been running smoothly in Bright Moon. Salineas was about ninety-nine percent rebuilt. Perfuma was helping Scorpia figure out how to rule her new kingdom. Frosta was kicking ass as Snows' princess. It was Bow, who had suggested the four of them spend a few days with his dads. Micah was more

than able to cover for Glimmer while she was out and as he put it, the four of them deserved a vacation!

For the most part, Bow and Glimmer had been able to relax. Adora… hadn't. And that meant Catra hadn't as well.

"So…" Catra began, glancing behind her shoulder. Adora was a few paces behind her, still looking around the meadow. She couldn't help but notice how Adora's gaze would flicker up to the tops of the trees they walked past, as if something might be waiting in the branches to jump the two of them.

"Are… Are you… Okay?" Catra finally asked.

Adora stopped. Her brow furrowed in confusion. Catra took one more step and paused. She waited before turning around. Back when they were kids, and they would check up on each other, the one who had been asked if they were okay, always shook the question off and would sprint past the other, challenging them to a race or a game of tag. Anything really, to avoid the question. To make the other forget. Usually, it was Adora asking her if everything was alright.

Catra didn't like feelings. She didn't understand them. She was working on that though! With Bow's help! And Perfuma's… And maybe Scorpia too… Feelings were weird! She hated them. She loathed them. Stupid feelings.

Still… She didn't want Adora to be stuck in her feelings (if that's what the problem was). If Adora decided to run and use a competition or a game to avoid them, then Catra wanted to be ready. Sure, Adora may be fast, but Catra was faster. She had full confidence that she would be able to outrun Adora and even tackle her to the ground if needed.
Adora would open up to her! And whatever the issue was, Catra would do her damndest to fix it!

"Y-yeah… Are… Are you?" Adora asked. Catra didn't miss the way the blonde's voice wavered. The way it didn't sound like herself.

Usually, Adora was confident when she spoke. That confidence wasn't there now. And that scared Catra.

"Yeah. I'm fine," Catra answered, turning around so she was facing Adora now. Despite herself, a small frown formed on Catra's face. Adora looked… so… uncertain. Her brow somehow looked even more furrowed than before. The dark circles under her eyes seemed even more prominent. The spark of hope and determination that she had held in her (gorgeous) blue-gray eyes throughout her life (their early days in the Horde, their skirmishes after Adora's defection), seemed as if it would be snuffed out at any moment.

Catra's tail whipped behind her. She wanted to reach out. She longed to grab Adora's arm and run with her. Run. Far away. From whatever it was that weighed so heavily on her. Adora had done the same for her. Many times, in fact!

Throughout her life, Adora had been there. She had stood before her. Had stood beside her. She had been like a bright, shining light in the darkness that was the Horde. That was ~~her~~ their childhood.

Adora needed her. Adora needed– An idea formed in Catra's head then. A small smile flickered over her frown. Her tail slowly stopped whipping anxiously behind her. It swayed leisurely now. Catra took a step forward. Another step. Another and– She grabbed Adora's hand. The blonde's face reddened. Catra pushed aside the feelings that sight brought. With her other hand, she reached up, and gingerly cupped Adora's cheek.

Adora closed her eyes. She leaned into Catra's touch. A tiny, little, satisfied smile formed on Adora's lips. Catra longed to bring her hand down, to trace Adora's face with her fingers. She thought about her fingers on Adora's lips. She thought about their lips meeting.

The dark circles under Adora's eyes. So prevalent. Adora seemed to sway slightly where she stood. She was unbalanced. Her breathing seemed more relaxed now. That was good!

…It still wasn't as calmed as Catra would have liked it to be though…

Catra slowly lowered her hand from Adora's cheek. Her fingers tenderly caressing the blonde's face. She leaned forward and kissed Adora's cheek. As she pulled away, she couldn't help but notice the way Adora's pale skin brightened like a tomato. It was already red before. How had it turned even more red?!

Adora opened her eyes. A questioning, longing look was in them. Catra wanted to kiss her again. And again. And again.

But that wasn't the only thing Adora needed right now, was it? Catra would have happily spent the rest of the day, the rest of her life, kissing Adora. Holding her tight. And she would. The two of them had their whole lives ahead of them to do that.

Catra pulled back and slid her free hand into Adora's. She stared into Adora's eyes. The spark seemed to flicker back to life. It was just slightly. It probably wouldn't have been noticeable to anyone else, but it was something!

"Come on, dummy," Catra beckoned her gently, "let's go sit down for a moment and rest."

Adora nodded. Catra let go of Adora's left hand and then led her to one of the nearby trees. Still holding one hand, the two slowly and carefully lowered themselves to sit down under the sprawling branches of the tree. Bits of sunlight filtered through the gaps in the leaves. It felt warm. It felt good.

With her free hand, Catra reached around Adora and guided her to lie down. The blonde's head was now resting in Catra's lap. A soft breeze came over the meadow. The leaves above them rustled, causing Adora's eyes to widen and her body to stiffen, as if there was a nearby threat.

"Hey." To Catra's relief, her voice seemed to be enough to pry Adora away from whatever was going on in her mind. From

whatever threat she believed was following them. "It's okay. We're safe."

Adora nodded. It looked numb and unconvinced. Catra took a deep breath. How could she help Adora? What monstrosities plagued her? Catra absent-mindedly began to run her fingers through Adora's hair. Her fingers intertwined with rich, blonde, soft locks. She still held Adora's right hand in hers. She felt a slight squeeze on her hand. Catra squeezed it back. She glanced down. Adora's eyes were closed. Her breathing seemed relaxed.

Maybe if she could get Adora to take a nap for a bit… Maybe that would help? Hopefully.

…Maybe… Maybe being out here… Away from everyone else. Maybe that would help Adora finally sleep?

There were times in the Horde where one of them would have trouble sleeping. Nightmares or dread would keep them awake. What had they done for each other to help the other sleep? Oh wait!

"I don't know what the trouble's been…" Catra began to sing softly. She felt Adora snuggled her head further into her lap.

A few hours in the meadow. Adora safe, and sleeping in her lap. Catra leaned her back against the tree behind her. The song was one she had heard Bow sing to Glimmer once. She wasn't sure if she completely understood it but it was one of the few she knew.

"But it's too much to get over you…"

End Notes

Any kudos and/or comments are deeply appreciated! Due to bots, I have limited my fics to just users being able to comment. I am considering moving most of my fics to being limited to registered users. If you're reading without an account, I highly recommend creating an account. There's a lot of great SPOP fics that are hidden due to the influx of bots and AI. Some of my favorite fics to read are now limited to only registered users.

Also, if you like my work, I have numerous other SPOP fics I've posted and I've also been doing better about publicly bookmarking some of my favorite fics! There's a lot of great authors in the SPOP community! Lisra, Lyssa, Canadian Bear, N7punk, Notebook Wizard, to name a few. I just love this IP and I want to support my fellow authors and recommend them as well!

Thank you so much for reading!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!